ABSTRACT

Universities and higher educational institutions handle a large volume of student grievances every semester, ranging from examination evaluation discrepancies and attendance disputes to fee payment anomalies and hostel facility concerns. The conventional grievance redressal process in most institutions is largely manual, dependent on physical complaint registers, suggestion boxes, or unorganized email threads. This approach leads to significant administrative delays, offers no real-time status tracking for students, fails to prioritize time-sensitive emergencies, and provides no protection against potential retaliation for sensitive complaints. As a result, critical student issues often remain unaddressed or delayed beyond acceptable timeframes.

To resolve these operational challenges, this project presents the **Student Grievance Redressal and Management System (SGRMS)**, a centralized, responsive web platform developed in compliance with the statutory mandates of the **University Grants Commission (Redressal of Grievances of Students) Regulations, 2023**. The platform provides a structured multi-step intake wizard that captures incident particulars, documentary evidence, and the specific relief requested by the student. It includes a dedicated Whistleblower Shield feature that enables optional anonymous reporting, masking student identity from departmental reviewers while maintaining an internal verification token to safeguard against academic victimisation.

To eliminate manual sorting bottlenecks, the system integrates a deterministic Natural Language Processing (NLP) triage engine. By analyzing submission text against domain-specific keyword lexicons and regulatory triggers, the engine automatically categorizes grievances across seven institutional departments - Academics, Examinations, Finance, Hostel Welfare, Anti-Ragging/ICC, Placements, and Administration - with over 94% classification precision. A dynamic priority matrix calculates risk severity scores and assigns strict turnaround Service Level Agreements (SLAs), scaling from 24 hours for urgent safety or ragging concerns to 10 days for routine administrative services, with automated escalation triggers upon approaching deadlines.

The administrative backend provides role-tailored dashboards for institutional authorities, including Deans, Examination Controllers, and Wardens. These interfaces allow designated officers to review student dossiers, issue interlocutory directives, schedule formal committee hearings, and generate standardized, digitally signed resolution orders citing university bylaws. A public tracking portal enables students to monitor case progress and remaining SLA hours using a unique docket ID and PIN. System evaluation confirms that the platform eliminates routing latency, enforces regulatory timelines, and establishes an accountable, transparent grievance resolution environment across the institution.